



Warm up

Mythical creatures are beings that only exist in mythology, legends or folklore, and do not exist in the real world. Match the mythical creatures given below to their descriptions.

Mythical Creatures



1. yeti

a. a creature with a woman's head and body, and a fish's tail instead of legs



2. werewolf

b. a large, hairy, ape-like being believed to live in the forests of North America



3. mermaid

c. a creature that feeds on the blood of other people



4. vampire

d. a large, ape-like creature covered with hair, believed to live in the snowy Himalayan mountains



5. Bigfoot

e. an eagle-like creature known for being reborn from its ashes



6. phoenix

f. a person who can shape-shift into a wolf typically under a full moon



Let us read about a boy named Danny who loved the stories that his father told him.



My father was not what you would call an educated man and I doubt if he had read twenty books in his life. But he was a marvellous storyteller. He used to make up a bedtime story for me every single night and the best ones turned into serials and went on for many nights **running**.

running: (here) one after another

One of them, which must have gone on for at least fifty nights, was about an enormous fellow called ‘The Big Friendly Giant’, or ‘The BFG’ for short. The BFG was three times as tall as an ordinary man and his hands were as big as **wheelbarrows**. He lived in a vast underground **cavern** not far from our **filling station** and he only came out into the open when it was dark.

Pick out two synonyms for the word ‘huge’ from the story.

Inside the cavern, he had a powder factory where he made more than a hundred different kinds of magic powder.

Occasionally, as he told his stories, my father would **stride** up and down, waving his arms and **wagging** his fingers. But mostly he would sit close to me on the edge of my **bunk** and speak very softly.

“The Big Friendly Giant makes his magic powders out of the dreams that children dream when they are asleep,” he said.

“How?” I asked. “Tell me how, Dad.”

“Dreams, my love, are very mysterious things. You see, they float around in the night air like little clouds, searching for sleeping people.”

“Can you see them?” I asked.

“Nobody can see them.”

“Then how does The Big Friendly Giant catch them?”

“Ah,” my father said. “That is the interesting part. A dream, you see, as it goes **drifting** through the night air, makes a tiny buzzing-humming sound—a sound so soft and low, it is impossible for ordinary people to hear it. But The BFG can hear it easily. His sense of hearing is absolutely fantastic.”

I loved the far, **intent** look on my father’s face when he was telling a story. His face was pale and still and distant, **unconscious** of everything around him.

“The BFG,” he said, “can hear the **tread** of a ladybird’s footsteps as she walks across a leaf. He can hear the whisperings of ants as they **scurry** around in the soil talking to one another.



wheelbarrows: small hand-pushed carts **cavern:** a cave **filling station:** a petrol pump **stride:** walk with long steps
wagging: moving something with short movements from side to side or up and down **bunk:** a narrow bed that is fixed to a wall
drifting: moving in a slow and steady manner **intent:** showing strong interest and attention
unconscious: unaware **tread:** the sound made while walking **scurry:** move quickly with short steps

He can hear the sudden **shrill** cry of pain a tree gives out when a woodman cuts into it with an axe. Ah yes, my darling, there is a whole world of sounds around us that we cannot hear because our ears are simply not sensitive enough.”

Why are we not able to hear the sound of a dream?

“What happens when he catches the dreams?” I asked.

“He **imprisons** them in glass bottles and **screws** the tops down tight,” my father said. “He has thousands of these bottles in his cave.”

“Does he catch bad dreams as well as good ones?”

“Yes,” my father said. “He catches both. But he only uses the good ones in his powders.”

“What does he do with the bad ones?”

“He **explodes** them.”



What does The BFG use in his powders?

It is impossible to tell you how much I loved my father. When he was sitting close to me on my bunk, I would reach out and slide my hand into his and then he would fold his long fingers around my fist, holding it tight.

“What does The BFG do with his powders after he has made them?” I asked.

“**In the dead of the night**,” my father said, “he goes **prowling** through the villages, searching for houses where children are asleep. Because of his great height, he can reach windows that are one and even two flights up and when he finds a room with a sleeping child, he opens his suitcase ... ”

“His suitcase?” I said.

“The BFG always carries a suitcase and a **blowpipe**,” my father said. “The blowpipe is as long as a **lamp post**. The suitcase is for powders. So he opens the suitcase and selects exactly the right powder ... and he puts it into the blowpipe ... and he slides the blowpipe in through the open window ... and *poof* ... he blows in the powder ... and the powder floats around the room ... and the child breathes it in ...”

shrill: loud and forceful **imprisons**: locks **screws**: (here) closes a lid by turning it round and round
explodes: bursts **in the dead of the night**: middle of the night, when it's too dark **prowling**: moving quietly and carefully around an area **blowpipe**: (here) a long tube for blowing powder **lamp post**: street light

“And then what?” I asked.

“And then, Danny, the child begins to dream a marvellous and fantastic dream ... and when the dream reaches its most marvellous and fantastic moment ... then the magic powder really takes over ... and suddenly the dream is not a dream any longer but a real happening ... and the child is not asleep in bed ... he is fully awake and is actually in the place of the dream and is taking part ... in the whole thing ... I mean really taking part ... in real life. More about that tomorrow. It’s getting late. Good night, Danny. Go to sleep.”



My father kissed me and then he turned down the **wick** of the little **paraffin lamp** until the flame went out. He seated himself in front of the **wood stove**, which now made a lovely red glow in the dark room.

Adapted from *Danny the Champion of the World*

Roald Dahl (1916–1990) was a British author who was born in Cardiff, Wales. He wrote many novels and short stories, both for children and adults. His stories for children like *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory* and *Matilda* continue to be popular and are known for their unique sense of humour and unexpected endings.



In this section, we will:

- remember details about the story.
- infer and interpret the main ideas of the story. (C-2.1, C-2.2, C-3.2)

Make connections

Map the story

Answer the following questions based on the story.

- Here are some sentences that tell us how The BFG makes dreams. Put them in the right sequence by numbering them.
 - He blows out the powder through a blowpipe.
 - The children breathe in the powder that floats around the room.
 - He finds a room with a sleeping child.
 - The BFG goes to houses where children are asleep.
 - He opens his suitcase and selects a powder.



wick: the piece of string at the centre of an oil lamp

paraffin lamp: a lamp that uses paraffin, which is a kind of fuel

wood stove: a stove that uses wood as fuel

2. Authors build **characters** by describing them to us. Fill in the blanks to complete the description of The BFG.
- very tall: three times as tall as an ordinary man, tall enough to reach _____
 - very large: hands as large as _____
 - home: lives in a _____ close to the filling station
 - usually goes out only _____
 - always carries _____ and _____

Deep dive

Answer the following questions with reference to context.

1. *But he was a marvellous storyteller. He used to make up a bedtime story for me every single night and the best ones turned into serials and went on for many nights running.*

RECALL

- Who was being talked about in these lines?
- What else had the narrator mentioned about the person?

INFER

- In your own words, describe what a 'serial' is. Why do you think Danny liked the serials the best?

ANALYSE

- How do serial comic strips stand apart from regular stories?

2. *"Ah yes, my darling, there is a whole world of sounds around us that we cannot hear because our ears are simply not sensitive enough."*

RECALL

- List the sounds that The BFG could hear but we cannot.

INFER

- Describe how the sounds helped The BFG to catch the dreams.

ANALYSE

- How are sounds used for information, safety and warning in our daily lives? For example, a school bell marks the end of a class.

Read, reflect and write

- According to Danny's father, what happens when the magic powder really takes over?
- Danny's father was a marvellous storyteller. Why do you think it is important for children to read and listen to stories? Give an example of how a story (or many stories) have helped you.
- What do you think Danny's father told him the following night? Write a paragraph to continue his story.

Integrate

The setting of the story is night-time—a time when we need to take extra care to use energy in a sustainable way. Create a to-do list for switching off all appliances in your home at night. With the help of grown-ups, calculate how much energy you will save. Find out about Earth Hour and discuss in class how it raises awareness regarding energy conservation.



In this section, we will:

- recognize words ending with *-ant* and *-ous*, based on their meanings or usage in context (C-4.2)

Word wall



-ant words

We just read a story about a *giant*. Now, use the clues given below to discover more words that end with *-ant*.

- a person who participates in competitions: contestant
- emitting bright and glowing light: _____
- far away: _____
- brave: _____
- a very young child or baby: _____

-ous words

Marvellous, *enormous* and *mysterious* are all words that end with the letters *-ous*.

Each sentence given below has a scrambled *-ous* word in brackets. Unscramble it and use it to complete the sentence. One has been done for you.

- Is the disease (OUSTAGICON) contagious ?
- Everybody crowded around the (AFUSOM) _____ actor, wanting to shake hands with him.
- My grandmother is an (VNETADUSOUR) _____ lady who loves travelling to new places.
- My brother is very (USOTSIUD) _____. He always finishes his homework before going out to play.
- Dinosaurs were (UMESNORO) _____ beasts, much larger than any animals we can see today.
- She wants to lead a space mission one day. She is quite (TMIASOUBI) _____.



Grammar time



Prepositions of time

Read the given sentence.

- The story of The Big Friendly Giant must have gone on **for** at least fifty nights.

In this sentence, *for* is used as a **preposition of time**.

A **preposition** is a word that we usually use before a noun or a pronoun to show **position, movement or time**.

ANCHOR CHART

Prepositions of time and their uses

Prepositions of time tell us **when** or for **how long** an event or action takes place.

during

used to express **when** an action takes place

- I spoke about my Moscow trip **during** dinner.



till

used to express for **how long** an action takes place

- We waited **till** dinner time.



On, at and in

show a **specific moment** in time.

on

with **days and dates**

- I will go to school **on** Monday.
- World Book Day is celebrated **on** 23 April.



at

with **noon, night, midnight;** with a **particular time** of day

- The train arrives **at** night.
- The match will begin **at** twelve o'clock.



in

with **other parts of the day; months, years, seasons**

- I like to read **in** the afternoon.
- My grandmother was born **in** 1950.
- Ice cream is a treat **in** summers!



1. Write three answers to the following questions using **on, at and in**.

a. When will you come over to my house?

I will come over _____.

I will come over _____.

I will come over _____.



b. When do we have the test?

We have the test _____.

We have the test _____.

We have the test _____.

Prepositions also show us for **how long** something has happened. These prepositions show us a *period of time* or *extended time*. Read the table given below.

Preposition	Use	Example
by	not later than a particular time	Finish your science project by four o'clock.
during	through the entire stretch of time	I felt very sleepy during the long bus ride.
for	a length of time	May I borrow your bicycle for an hour?
since	a point of time in the past from which an action began	I have been living here since 2004.
from ... to from ... till/ until	two points in time showing duration	I play games in the evening from Monday to Wednesday. I will be in school from 9 a.m. till 3 p.m.
till/until	shows a time beyond which an action is discontinued	You can stay here until tomorrow.
in/within	during a period of time	Finish writing your answers within an hour.

2. In each of the sentences given below, a preposition has been used incorrectly. Underline the wrong preposition and replace it with the correct one. One has been done for you.

a. Finish your work within six o'clock. _____ *by*

b. I have been living here since five years. _____

c. The teacher said that she would be free from an hour. _____

d. I have been waiting for you from half an hour. _____

e. We are going on a vacation for May 5 till July 2. _____

3. Fill in the blanks using the prepositions of time given in the help box.

a. This test must be finished _____ an hour.

b. Farah went to Rome _____ two weeks.

c. You must reach there _____ 9 p.m. or you will miss the train.

d. The television show starts _____ 5 p.m.

e. It has been raining _____ the afternoon.

for
at
by
since
within

Pronunciation



Same spelling, different pronunciation

Given below are pairs of sentences where the underlined words have the same spelling. However, the underlined word is pronounced differently in each sentence to fit its use. Read these sentences aloud with your teacher and check if you are pronouncing the words correctly.

- You must read this lovely book. I have already read this book.
- Turn the pages carefully or they will tear.
A tear rolled down his cheek when he heard the sad story.
- I'll help you in just a minute.
Look at the minute details in this painting.
- We saw the live performance in Mumbai. My cousins live in Coorg.

Before words beginning with vowel sounds, 'the' is pronounced as 'thee'. Before words beginning with consonant sounds, 'the' is pronounced as 'thuh'.

Write well



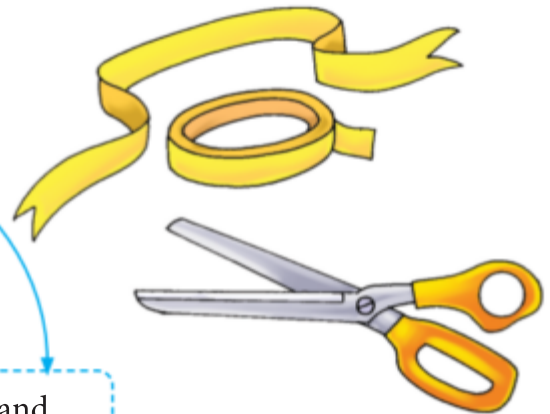
Procedure or how-to writing

The story described how The BFG made his powders. Use the format given below to describe the steps or process of something you love to do.

PROCEDURE WRITING

It includes:

- a list of materials
 - step-by-step instructions
 - numbered steps and/or transition words
 - action words
- chop kneed colour rotate mix
fill cut jump pour dig
- pictures to demonstrate the step



Transition words help us to sequence information and make it easier to follow.

- beginning: *first, at first, to start, to begin, first of all, ...*
- middle: *second/third, next, then, as soon as, ...*
- end: *last, at the end, finally, ...*



Listen and speak well

1. Listen to the riddles quietly and think out loud to help Danny tick (✓) the correct answer.

a. dog	☐	footstep	☐	shadow	☐
b. spectacles	☐	button	☐	kite	☐
c. insects	☐	potatoes	☐	moles	☐
d. calendar	☐	diary	☐	watch	☐
e. gold	☐	wealth	☐	nothing	☐

2. The giant is *gigantic*, *gentle*, *gifted* and *generous*. Choose an adjective that begins with the same letter as your name. Choose an adjective that best describes you. For example, *daring* Daman, *zealous* Zara and *brave* Bani. Divide yourselves into groups of 4-5 members and portray the chosen adjectives through role-play in class.



ambitious	adorable	brave	bubbly	calm	capable
charming	cheerful	confident	determined	diligent	encouraging
energetic	entertaining	enthusiastic	faithful	fearless	frank
friendly	funny	generous	gentle	goofy	happy
helpful	hilarious	imaginative	jolly	joyous	kind
knowledgeable	lively	loving	lucky	modern	mischievous
noble-minded	obedient	peaceful	playful	perfect	punctual
quirky	quick-witted	responsible	sincere	skilful	smiling
talented	thoughtful	tough	unusual	upbeat	vivacious
warm	willing	wise	witty	zany	zealous

